

Call for Papers: HotSense 2026

The 2nd Workshop on Thermal Sensing and Computing

Co-located with UbiComp/ISWC 2026

Location: Shanghai, China

Dates: October 11–12, 2026 (the workshop will be scheduled on one of these days)

Overview

Thermal sensing is emerging as a practical, privacy-aware sensing modality for ubiquitous and wearable computing. HotSense 2026 aims to gather the growing community around thermal sensing and computing to share advances, identify open challenges, and accelerate real-world impact.

Topics of Interest (including but not limited to)

- Human sensing (e.g., gesture, activity, and pose recognition) using thermal/infrared data
- Thermal localization and tracking
- Thermal depth estimation and ranging
- Thermal imaging and space reconstruction
- Robotic perception and navigation augmented by thermal vision
- Material sensing and object classification using thermal signatures
- Privacy-preserving sensing for homes, healthcare, and interactions
- Thermal sensing for building occupancy and energy efficiency
- Thermal generative models and synthesis
- Multimodal learning and foundation models for thermal perception
- Lower-power and embedded systems for thermal sensing
- Large-scale and real-world thermal sensing systems
- Novel sensors, optics, and metasurface designs
- Novel applications in health, AR/VR, cities, emergency response, low-altitude, etc

Important Dates (tentative)

- Paper submission deadline: **August 15, 2026**
- Notification of acceptance: **September 5, 2026**
- Camera-ready deadline: **September 15, 2026**
- Workshop dates: **October 11–12, 2026**

Organizers

- Chenshu Wu, The University of Hong Kong, HK SAR, China
- Fanglin Bao, Westlake University, China
- Mayank Goel, Carnegie Mellon University, USA
- Petteri Nurmi, University of Helsinki, Finland

Submission, Review, and Publication

Submissions must be original and not under review elsewhere. Papers should be submitted in PDF format, be no longer than *5 pages excluding references*, and follow the *UbiComp/ISWC (IMWUT)* templates. Accepted papers will be presented via lightning talks and posters, and will be published in the *UbiComp/ISWC Adjunct Proceedings and ACM Digital Library*.

Website: <https://hotsense.github.io/> (This website will be updated soon.)